

MCP in *plain English*

MCP is one of the most common words thrown around in GTM right now. Yet, it is rarely explained in simple terms. This is the starting point: understand it first, then trust it, use it and stretch it.

THE SHORT VERSION

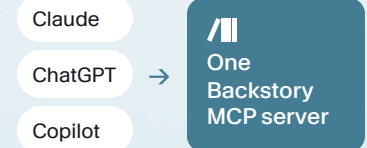
MCP (Model Context Protocol) is a standard that lets AI clients like Claude or ChatGPT connect to tools and use them without every integration being built from scratch.

BEFORE MCP 9 builds

	CRM	Email	Calls
Claude			
ChatGPT			
Copilot			

Every tool needed a custom integration for every AI client.

NOW 1 build



One MCP server → multiple AI clients can use the tool.

TWO WAYS TO PICTURE IT

ANALOGY 1

The filing cabinet

Backstory is the filing cabinet.

Claude is the analyst.

MCP is the badge that opens specific drawers.

Each tool is one drawer.

ANALOGY 2

The standard plug

One standard plug. *Every appliance. Every wall.*

Before, every device needed its own custom connection to your wall. The standard plug → any appliance works.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR GTM TEAMS

01

Context where you work.

Ask your assistant about an account and get answers from Backstory, without switching tabs.

02

Connect once.

One server works across the AI clients your team already uses, so no one waits on a custom build.

03

Answers stay grounded.

The assistant reads the emails, meetings and CRM activity Backstory captures.

"Catch me up on this deal"

"What are the key risks?"

MCP IS PORTABLE

Connect Backstory once and take it with you. The same connection works in Claude, Copilot and other AI clients, so switching or adding assistants doesn't mean rebuilding.

DID YOU KNOW?

An AI client can only use the tools an MCP server chooses to expose. It sees the drawers it has been given, not the whole cabinet.

WHY THIS MATTERS, TACTICALLY

A standard way for AI tools to connect *directly* to Backstory data

01 · THE PROTOCOL

One standard, any client

Claude, Copilot and a growing list of AI clients speak MCP. Backstory exposes one server; you connect whichever assistant your team already lives in.

02 · THE BRIDGE

Live data, real permissions

The assistant sees accounts, deals and customer interactions in real time, through the signed-in user's own Backstory permissions.

03 · THE DIFFERENCE

No copy, paste and hope

Instead of pasting a summary into a chat window and hoping it's current, the assistant reads the record itself.

"Which of my accounts went quiet this month?" Asked in the assistant, answered from Backstory.

EXAMPLE

Situation search

SITUATION_SEARCH

Finds historically comparable past deals to use as precedent for a live one.

MCP ONLY

Not exposed anywhere else in Backstory. If a rep wants precedent, MCP is the only door.

IN PILOT

Available to pilot customers now. Still being tuned for the right level of granularity.

WHY IT MATTERS FOR GTM

Reps stop guessing how a deal like theirs was won. Managers can coach from precedent instead of memory.

Find a similar deal to this one and tell me: how we were able to land the customer, and what I should avoid as I navigate this sales cycle: <crm.example.com/opportunity/006...>

 Loaded tools, used Backstory MCP integration >

I pulled up the current opportunity and ran it against similar historical deals. The closest match is a comparable net-new pilot, and I've pulled patterns across four similar wins to round out what to avoid.

Closest match: a net-new pilot at a mid-market software company

Nearly identical situation: a paid pilot, a buyer waiting on internal review, and a deal that needed rework on commercial structure.

How it was landed

- Separated subscription pricing from services pricing, which cleared up buyer confusion
- Ran a technical alignment session so stakeholders had what they needed for sign-off
- Sent the order form the moment approvals cleared

Outcome: Signed and moved straight into implementation.

What to avoid

- Don't let integration or security questions stall in a single meeting

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE · MOCK DATA

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOUR TEAM

Your AI assistant becomes an expert on *your* business

BEFORE MCP

- ✗ Copy account data out of Backstory, paste it into a chat, get generic advice
- ✗ Ask vague questions with no context behind them
- ✗ Switch between tools all day
- ✗ Analyze and report on data by hand

WITH MCP

- Your assistant already knows your accounts, deals and history
- Ask specific questions: "What are the risks on the Halden Freight deal?"
- Get insights based on your actual data, not generic best practices
- Work faster without leaving the assistant

ASK IT LIKE THIS

ACCOUNT EXECUTIVES

"What should I focus on this week?"

Reviews your pipeline, flags at-risk deals and suggests priorities.

"Help me prep for my call with Halden Freight."

Summarizes recent activity, key contacts and talking points.

CUSTOMER SUCCESS

"Which accounts need attention?"

Reads engagement patterns and flags accounts showing risk.

"Summarize the last month with Corvia Health."

Gives a full activity overview in one answer.

SALES MANAGERS

"How is my team tracking this quarter?"

Surfaces coaching opportunities across the team.

"Which deals are most likely to close this month?"

Weights opportunities by activity and engagement.

WHAT MCP DOES

- ✓ Gives AI assistants your specific business context
- ✓ Returns faster, more relevant answers
- ✓ Cuts manual data gathering and analysis
- ✓ Grounds insights in your actual data

WHAT IT DOESN'T DO

- ✗ Replace human judgment or relationships
- ✗ Take actions in your CRM on its own
- ✗ Work well if Backstory data isn't up to date
- ✗ Replace a good sales process

WORKS WITH

Claude Desktop

Microsoft Copilot

Cursor

Goose

n8n

ChatGPT

Gemini

QUICK ANSWERS

Do we need to change how we work?

No. Keep using Backstory as you do today. MCP gives your AI tools access to that data.

What does it cost?

MCP is included with your Backstory subscription. The AI tools themselves may have their own cost.

GETTING STARTED

01

Take stock

Which AI tools does your team already use?

02

Pick use cases

Which prompts above would save the most time?

03

Connect

Work with Backstory to set up MCP.

04

Train

Show your team how to ask better questions.

05

Measure

Track time saved and answer quality.